

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 2 · CLASSICS

Grammar

B1+/B2

Simple Past, Past Continuous & used to: Narrating Past Events and Life Stories · Expressing Preferences: prefer, would rather and comparatives

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10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Discover the grammar from examples, explain the rule in your own words and use it correctly in context.

Simple Past, Past Continuous & used to: Narrating Past Events and Life Stories

1 · NOTICE

- The young director **grew up** in a small coastal town before she moved to the city to study film.
- While the actors **were rehearsing** the final scene, a sudden storm hit the old studio.
- As a child, she **used to watch** black-and-white classics with her grandmother every Sunday.
- By the time the credits **rolled**, most of the audience **was wiping** away tears.

Which sentences describe a single completed action, which describe an action in progress that was interrupted, and which describe a repeated habit from the past that isn't true anymore?

B Build sentences

Use the cues to build true sentences about past events and life stories. Choose Simple Past, Past Continuous or used to.

e.g.

the author

grow up / in a village

before he became famous

The author grew up in a village before he became famous.

1.

she

write / her first novel

at the age of nineteen

2.

while the crew

film / the final scene

it started raining heavily

3.

as a teenager, he

use to / read / one book a week

4.

the composer

not use to / like / his own soundtrack

at first

5.

? / you

ever / watch

a film that changed the way you thought

C Your turn

Write four sentences about a book or film you remember from your childhood: what you used to do, one completed event, and one thing that was happening when something else interrupted it.

When I was younger, I used to...

One day, while I was reading/watching...

I finally finished the book/film when...

I remember that I...

RULE

Use the Simple Past for completed past actions (grew up, wrote, watched). Use the Past Continuous (was/were + -ing) for actions in progress in the past, often interrupted by another action. Use used to + base verb for repeated past habits or states that are no longer true.

TR Tamamlanmış geçmiş zaman eylemleri için Simple Past kullanılır (grew up, wrote, watched). Geçmişte devam eden ve genellikle başka bir eylem tarafından kesilen eylemler için Past Continuous kullanılır (was/were + -ing). Artık doğru olmayan, tekrarlanan geçmiş alışkanlıklar veya durumlar için used to + fiil kullanılır.

When?

We use these forms to narrate the plot of a book or film, to tell the life story of an author or director, or to talk about our own past habits and experiences with stories.

TR Bir kitabın ya da filmin olay örgüsünü, bir yazarın veya yönetmenin hayatını anlatırken ya da geçmişteki alışkanlıklarımızdan bahsederken bu yapıları kullanırız.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
She wrote three novels before she turned thirty. He used to read comic books every evening.	They didn't finish the film because the ending was too sad. She didn't use to enjoy classic literature.	Did the director grow up near the sea? What were you doing when the twist was revealed?	Yes, she did. / No, she didn't. I was watching the final scene.

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
While she was writing the novel, she has three young children.	While she was writing the novel, she had three young children.	When describing a past state alongside another past action, use the Simple Past, not the Present Perfect. TR Geçmişteki bir durumu anlatırken Present Perfect değil, Simple Past kullanılır.
He use to watch old films every Sunday.	He used to watch old films every Sunday.	In positive sentences, it is always 'used to', not 'use to'. TR 'used to' olumlu cümlede her zaman 'used' şeklinde yazılır; 'use' değil.
The audience was crying when the film ended suddenly.	The audience was crying when the film ended. / The audience cried when the film suddenly ended.	Be careful which action is the ongoing background action (Past Continuous) and which one interrupts it (Simple Past). TR İki eylemden hangisinin arka planda devam ettiğine, hangisinin onu kestiğine dikkat edin.

1 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- The novelist _____ her first bestseller when she was only twenty-two.
(a) wrote (b) was writing (c) use to write
- While the director _____ the final scene, the lead actor injured his leg.
(a) filmed (b) was filming (c) used to film
- As a child, I _____ read comic books every night, but now I prefer novels.
(a) used to (b) was (c) wrote

2 Complete with the correct form.

3 × 1 pts

- The composer _____ (grow up) in a musical family before he wrote his first film score.
- The audience _____ (still / watch) the credits when the lights suddenly came on.
- She _____ (not use to) enjoy poetry until her teacher introduced her to it.

3 Judge the sentence.

3 × 1 pts

- The novelist use to write every morning before breakfast. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- While she was reading the final chapter, she started crying. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- The director was direct his first film in 1998. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

4 Complete with the correct past form.

2 × 1 pts

Challenge

- A: What _____ you _____ (do) when you first heard the news about the sequel?
- B: I _____ (read) the first book, and I nearly _____ (drop) it from excitement!

5 Reorder the sentence.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

- to romantic used read novels she .

Expressing Preferences: prefer, would rather and comparatives

1 · NOTICE

- I **prefer** reading the book before watching the film adaptation.
- "Honestly, I **d rather** watch a classic than a new blockbuster," she admitted.
- For me, the novel is **far more moving** than the film ever could be.
- Of all the director's works, most critics agree this one is **the most thought-provoking**.

Which structures compare two specific things directly, and which one picks out the best or most extreme example from a whole group?

B Build sentences

Use the cues to build true sentences about preferences for books and films.

e.g. I prefer / classic novels modern thrillers
I prefer classic novels to modern thrillers.

- she would rather / read the book watch the adaptation

- this novel be / far more gripping the sequel

- for many critics this / be / the most moving film of the decade

- I not / prefer / remakes original films

- ? / you would rather / read a poem or watch a film about the same story

C Your turn

Write four sentences comparing a book and its film adaptation, or two classic stories you know, using *prefer*, *would rather* and at least one comparative or superlative.

I prefer...

I'd rather...

In my opinion, ... is more ... than ...

Of all the classics I know, ... is the most ...

RULE

'Prefer + noun/-ing' expresses a general preference (I prefer novels to films). 'Would rather + base verb' expresses a preference for a specific moment or situation (I'd rather read than watch TV). Use a comparative (more ... than) to compare two specific things directly, and a superlative (the most ...) to pick out the most extreme example in a whole group.

TR 'Prefer + isim/-ing' genel bir tercihi ifade eder (I prefer novels to films). 'Would rather + fiilin yalın hali' belirli bir anda ya da durumda yapılacak tercihi belirtir (I'd rather read than watch TV). İki şeyi doğrudan karşılaştırmak için karşılaştırma sıfatı (more ... than), bir grubun en uç örneğini belirtmek için ise üstünlük sıfatı (the most ...) kullanılır.

When?

We use these structures when comparing a book with its film adaptation, choosing between two classic works, or describing a work as the best or most striking example within a group.

TR Bir kitap ile filmini karşılaştırırken, iki klasik eser arasında tercih yaparken ya da bir eseri bir grup içinde en iyi/en etkileyici olarak nitelendirirken bu yapıları kullanırız.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
I prefer reading to watching TV.	He doesn't prefer remakes to originals.	Do you prefer books or films?	I prefer books. / I prefer films.
She'd rather finish the novel first.	I wouldn't rather watch the sequel; I'd rather reread the book.	Would you rather watch the classic or the remake?	I'd rather watch the classic.

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
I prefer books than films.	I prefer books to films.	With 'prefer', use 'to' (not 'than') when comparing two things. TR 'Prefer' ile karşılaştırma yaparken 'than' değil 'to' kullanılır.
I'd rather to read than watch.	I'd rather read than watch.	'Would rather' is followed by the base verb, without 'to'. TR 'Would rather' fiilin yalın halini alır, 'to' kullanılmaz.
This novel is more interesting than the film ever could.	This novel is more interesting than the film could ever be.	Pay attention to word order in comparative structures with modal verbs. TR Karşılaştırmada fiil sırasına dikkat edilmelidir.

6 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- I _____ classic novels _____ modern thrillers.
☐ a prefer / to ☐ b prefer / than ☐ c would rather / to
- Honestly, I _____ read the poem again before we discuss it.
☐ a prefer ☐ b 'd rather ☐ c the most
- For many readers, this is _____ ending in the whole series.
☐ a more moving ☐ b the most moving ☐ c moving than

7 Complete with the correct form.

3 × 1 pts

- She _____ (prefer) the original story _____ any of the remakes.
- I'd _____ (rather) reread an old favourite than start something new.
- This character is far _____ (interesting) than the protagonist.

8 Judge the sentence.

3 × 1 pts

- I prefer novels than short stories. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- I'd rather watch the film first. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- This is the more gripping book I have ever read. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

9 Complete with the correct preference form.

2 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. A: Would you _____ read the book or watch the film first?
2. B: I _____ (prefer) the book, because it's usually _____ (detailed) than the film.

10 Reorder the sentence.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. film's most the it is moving ending .
